

have a malfunctioning amygdala, any human being feels something after an experience. Your users are all human, and at the very least your design should make them feel like using your product or service again, rather than drive them away from it. However, UX design isn't about creating or designing that experience itself, rather it is about designing the framework that allows for the experience to take place. It is for the people, and by the people, as you will see. You, as the UX Designer, will merely be the enabling medium through which the magical process happens. That was a bit of an exaggeration, but the fact remains that it doesn't matter what you think will work or look good, because testing your design will soon change that. UX Design is a continuous process, a design cycle by design, as we will see in the forthcoming chapters.

As long there are consumers, there will be businesses, and businesses will make products and services that the consumers will interact with, to use. Interaction will occur at customer touch points, the majority of them being the interface of the product. Furthermore, the experiences that we are so concerned with, will always occur at these interfaces. So why then, is this Fast Track about UX design, and not UI (User Interface) design?

UX != UI

Many design professionals, when asked to describe their work or profession, interchangeably use the terms UI and UX. Maybe they think they know what they are talking about, but clearly they don't. Is it just nomenclature? Where are they going wrong?

In short, semantics. User Experience design and User Interface design are not the same, just as Muay Thai and Mixed Martial Arts are not the same. They do not mean the same things. User Interface designers deal with the visible parts of the product that the users interact with. They design the framework for the input and output of information, basically everything that you actually see, or click on. This sounds a lot like UX, and that is because it is true that they share a lot in common. UI is a part of UX, but UX is so much more. Like UI, UX also has facets of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Visual Design, and Information Architecture. However, UX doesn't only deal with the interface, it deals with the relationship between the customer and the business/organization as a whole. UI is different from UX in nature, objective and scope. UI meets user needs, but UX has to align user needs with business needs. UI creates (the visual elements of) the product, UX creates (the emotional perception of) the brand. Just as in the case of Muay Thai and Mixed Martial Arts, UI is but a tool in the arsenal of UX. Interface is a